

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 3 2
♥ 10 9 4
♦ 9 8 4 2
♣ A Q 9

♠ K Q J 6 4
♥ A K J 7 6
♦ K 6
♣ 5



♠ 9 8
♥ Q 5 3
♦ J 10 7
♣ K 7 6 3 2

♠ 10 7 5
♥ 8 2
♦ A Q 5 3
♣ J 10 8 4

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			
Lead: ♠ 9			

It may be tempting to open 1♥, planning on Reversing in ♠ at your second turn to show your big hand.

Don't. A Reverse should always show an unbalanced hand with the first suit longer. So you open 1♠ and partner replies 2♠.

If you had opened 1♥ partner would have replied 1NT. Then when you Reversed with 2♠ he would have assumed you had a 4-card ♠ suit and would probably have put you back in ♥s, your known 5-card suit.

Things would have gotten confusing, to say the least.

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 9 8 5 2
 ♥ Q 10 4 3
 ♦ J 10
 ♣ 6 3

♠ 10 7 4

♥ K J 9 8

♦ K 7 3

♣ 9 8 5



♠ Q 6 3

♥ A 7 6

♦ Q 9 8 5

♣ Q J 2

♠ A K

♥ 5 2

♦ A 6 4 2

♣ A K 10 7 4

You would really love to pass. You have a terrible hand and you like the ♦s better than the ♣s.

But you are forced to bid. And since partner has 5 ♣s and only 4 ♦s, you should take him back to his first suit.

Mercifully he passes.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	3 ♣		
All Pass			
3 ♣ by South			
Lead: ♦ J			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 6 2
 ♥ J 9 4 2
 ♦ A 7 6 2
 ♣ 5 2

♠ K Q 10 5

♥ Q 8

♦ J 9 4

♣ Q J 9 7



♠ 9 8 4 3

♥ 10 7 5

♦ 3

♣ A 8 6 4 3

♠ J 7

♥ A K 6 3

♦ K Q 10 8 5

♣ K 10

When partner shows 17+ points with his Reverse you are sure you belong in game. Since he did not support your ♠s you know he doesn't have four of them. You also know you have an 8-card fit in ♦s, but surely nine tricks in Notrump will be easier than eleven in ♦s.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♥
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♣4			

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 8 7 4

♥ Q J 10

♦ 10 9 4

♣ Q 6

♠ Q 5 2

♥ A 8 6 3

♦ 7 5 3

♣ 8 4 3



♠ A K 9

♥ 9 7 4 2

♦ A 8 2

♣ J 9 5

♠ 6 3

♥ K 5

♦ K Q J 6

♣ A K 10 7 2

With 17 points you have a perfect hand for a Reverse. So you bid 2♦. Partner then says 3♣.

Partner's return to your ♣ suit shows he has fewer than 9 points. Although it is possible to devise a hand for him where your side could make 3NT, the risk is too great.

So you pass. It's a good thing, too.

West	North	East	South
			1♣
Pass	1♥	Pass	2♦
Pass	3♣		
All Pass			
3♣ by South			
Lead: ♠J			

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A K 9
♥ 10 6 5 3 2
♦ 10 7 5
♣ 5 4

♠ 10 8 5

♥ K Q 9 8 7 4

♦ 8 3

♣ 7 6



♠ Q 6 4 2

♥ A

♦ Q J 9 2

♣ Q J 10 2

♠ J 7 3

♥ J

♦ A K 6 4

♣ A K 9 8 3

You have 7 points, and basically nothing but s♥.

You must make a minimum bid, and the only reasonable one is 2♥. Despite his 17 points, partner passes.

West	North	East	South
			1♣
Pass	1♥	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥		
All Pass			
2♥ by North			
Lead: ♠4			